

ALFONSO MERENDINO

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EDUCATION

YALE UNIVERSITY

Ph.D. in Economics

New Haven, CT (US)

- Fully funded Ph.D. starting in July 2026.

BOCCONI UNIVERSITY

M.Sc. in Economic and Social Sciences (ESS)

Milan (Italy)

2022 - 2025

- Final Grade: 110/110 *cum laude*. GPA: 29.5/30.0.
- Ph.D.-level courses: "Probability Theory I" from the program in Statistics and Computer Science (Grade: 29/30), and Prof. T. Monacelli's second-year Ph.D. course "Advanced Macroeconomics IV" (audited).
- Thesis: *Supply Chain Uncertainty, Energy Prices, and Inflation*. Advisor: Prof. T. Monacelli.

B.Sc. in Economic and Social Sciences (BESS)

2019 - 2022

- Final Grade: 110/110 *cum laude*. GPA: 29.6/30.0.
- Thesis: *Coexistence of Temporary and Permanent Contracts: An Empirical Approach using Survival Analysis*. Advisor: Prof. T. M. Boeri.

NEW YORK UNIVERSITY

Visiting Student, Department of Economics

New York, NY (US)

Spring 2022

- Selected for Exchange Program with a single slot available among 100+ applicants. GPA: 3.96/4.0.
- Ph.D.-level course: "Stochastic Calculus" at the Courant Mathematics Department (Grade: A-).

LICEO CLASSICO G. GARIBALDI

5-year Italian high school diploma in Classical Studies

Palermo (Italy)

2014 - 2019

- Final Grade: 100/100 *cum laude*. Graduated in the top 1.6% nationwide.

WORK EXPERIENCE

EUROPEAN CENTRAL BANK

Trainee in economic modelling in the Euro Area External Sector and Euro Adoption Division

Frankfurt (Germany)

Sep 2025 - Mar 2026

- Presented joint work with Tommaso Monacelli, "Supply Chain Uncertainty, Energy Prices, and Inflation" at a DG-Economics internal seminar.
- Co-authored a new research paper (joint with Matteo Falagiarda) "Geopolitical Risk, Supply Chain Uncertainty, and Inflation: Evidence from Central and Eastern Europe."
- Supported policy requests on the tariff model in *Tariffs across the Supply Chain* (Gnolato-Montes Galdón-Stamato) and broader requests on the macroeconomic effects of monetary policy shocks; worked on an extension of the model to incorporate uncertainty.
- Served as Latvia forecast and country expert.

HARVARD UNIVERSITY

Research Assistant to Prof. S. Stantcheva

Remote (Milan, Italy)

Aug 2023 - May 2025

- Contributed to research using large-scale household surveys to understand people's preferences about inflation, trade, and other economic policies. Tasks included writing survey questions, collecting responses (Qualtrics), and data analysis (Python, RStudio, Stata).
- Conducted extensive literature reviews, analyzing both theoretical and empirical articles.

Social Economics Lab, Research Fellow

Aug 2023 - Present

BOCCONI UNIVERSITY

Research Assistant to Prof. T. Monacelli

Milan (Italy)

Feb - Jul 2025

- Assisted research on "Tariffs and Monetary Policy" and an upcoming paper on convenience yield shocks and the exchange rate; drafted model extensions and contributed mathematical derivations, proofs, calibrations, and Dynare simulations.

Academic Fellow: Teaching Assistant to Prof. T. Monacelli and Prof. L. Iovino

Aug 2024 - Feb 2025

- Prepared lecture slides for Prof. T. Monacelli's second-year Ph.D. course "Advanced Macroeconomics IV."
- Wrote lecture notes, exams, and graded assignments for the intermediate-level undergraduate course "Macroeconomics and Economic Policy" taught by Prof. L. Iovino within the B.Sc. in Economic and Social Sciences.

Research Assistant to Prof. M. P. Squicciarini

Jun - Oct 2021

- Assisted research on "Do Bishops Matter for Politics? Evidence From Italy," a paper in Economic History. Analyzed data with Stata and proposed changes to the model. Prepared monthly presentations and discussed the findings.

IGIER (INNOCENZO GASPARINI INSTITUTE FOR ECONOMIC RESEARCH)

Milan (Italy)

IGIER Researcher and Visiting Student (Mentor: Prof. T. Monacelli)

Feb 2023 - Apr 2025

- Worked on several independent research projects, with a focus on models, mathematical derivations, and calibrations using Dynare. Extensively reviewed the literature on the effects of nominal and real rigidities in New Keynesian models.

NORTHWESTERN UNIVERSITY, KELLOGG SCHOOL OF MANAGEMENT

Remote (Milan, Italy)

Research Assistant to Prof. N. Persico

Jul 2024 - Dec 2025

- Contributed to several research projects using large-scale surveys. Wrote survey questions, collected responses (Qualtrics), and analyzed data (Stata) using Principal Component Analysis and Structural Equation Modeling. Collaborated on drafting a theoretical model of people's tastes for freedom.

WORKING PAPERS

Supply Chain Uncertainty, Energy Prices, and Inflation

with Tommaso Monacelli (Bocconi), draft April 2026

- Using U.S. and Euro Area data, the paper shows that energy-price pass-through to inflation is state-dependent: it is stronger when supply-chain uncertainty is elevated and, in such states, energy prices become more informative about logistical conditions. The paper develops a New Keynesian model with energy and specialized inputs transported through a capacity-constrained network. When congestion binds, firms treat energy prices as noisy signals of future delivery delays and update beliefs through Bayesian learning. The resulting signal-extraction channel raises perceived marginal costs, generating an uncertainty wedge that amplifies and propagates transitory energy shocks to consumer inflation.

Tariffs, Uncertainty, and the Exchange Rate *with Tommaso Monacelli (Bocconi), upcoming at the second [Economic Policy PEGI Conference](#)*

- Studies how uncertainty about the persistence of tariff shocks shapes exchange-rate dynamics in a New Keynesian Small Open Economy with incomplete markets. Using U.S. data, the paper shows empirically that import tariff shocks have state-dependent effects: the exchange rate appreciates under low Structural Trade-Policy Uncertainty (S-TPU) but depreciates under high S-TPU. The paper rationalizes this finding in a model where agents observe current tariffs but do not know whether they reflect temporary measures or persistent changes in trade policy. The effect of tariffs on the exchange rate is decomposed into a static expenditure-switching channel, driven by the tariff currently in place, and a novel persistence channel, driven by uncertainty about future trade policy and the implied path of trade balances and net foreign assets.

Geopolitical Risk, Supply Chain Uncertainty, and Inflation: Evidence from Central and Eastern Europe *with Matteo Falagiarda (ECB), upcoming*

- Decomposes the Geopolitical Risk index (GPR) into supply- and demand-related components and studies their macroeconomic effects, with a special focus on Central and Eastern Europe. Shows how supply-related geopolitical risk operates through energy prices and supply-chain uncertainty, with stronger inflationary transmission in economies more exposed to imported energy and intermediate inputs.

CERTIFICATIONS, LANGUAGE & IT SKILLS

GRE General Test. Q165 (70th percentile), V161 (86th percentile), AWA 4.5 (83rd percentile) - Oct 2024.

Languages: Italian (native), English (excellent, TOEFL: 106/120, Oct 2024), Spanish (fair).

Computer skills: R, Stata, Python, MATLAB, Dynare, Microsoft Office, Qualtrics, LaTeX (excellent command). EViews (good command).

AWARDS AND SCHOLARSHIPS

Banca d'Italia Bonaldo Stringher "Particolarmente Meritevoli" Award	2026
Recognition awarded by Banca d'Italia within the Stringher–Mortara–Menichella scholarship competition.	
Economics Cowles Foundation Award	2026–2031
Scholarship awarded by the Cowles Foundation joint with the Yale Department of Economics and the Economic Growth Center (\$25,000).	
Zegna Founder's Scholarship	2026–2027
Merit-based scholarship supporting graduate study abroad (€10,000).	
Bocconi Graduate Merit Award	2022–2025
Merit-based full tuition waiver for Bocconi M.Sc. programs (€28,000).	
Registered in the Albo Nazionale delle Eccellenze	2019
List of Italian high school students graduating <i>cum laude</i> , compiled by the Italian Ministry of Education.	

EXTRA-CURRICULAR ACTIVITIES

Harvard Business School Online Course in Alternative Investments (*Jun-Jul 2021*)

Cuora Concept

- Joined the volunteering student association Cuora, published a brief for divulgation on [Central Bank Credibility and Inflation](#) (2020-2021). Founded and directed the [Research Division](#) (2021-2022). Managed the transition of the organization from a student association to a volunteering non-profit company.

Fellow at Economic Society for Bocconi Students (2022-present)

Corporate Hangar. The venture builder of the Prysmian Group.

- Designed and tested a startup idea (preliminary works started in Aug 2021) in the field of energy distribution. Presented the project to Corporate Hangar (venture builder of the Prysmian Group) and interned in a rotational program across the business advisory teams (*June-July 2022*).

Mediterranea Junior Golf Academy (2012 - 2019). HCP: 2 (54 is beginner; 0 is professional)